

Aircraft carrier

The first man to land an airplane successfully on a moving ship was Squadron Commander Edwin Harris Dunning, who in 1917 landed a Sopwith Pup on HMS *Furious*. Sadly, he was killed a few days later attempting to repeat the feat. But the development of the modern aircraft carrier—from those early beginnings to the production of the vast warships of today—has revolutionized naval warfare, allowing the deployment of aircraft in all parts of the globe away from land bases and homeland. Aircraft carriers really made an impact for the first time during World War II, when they were used by the Royal Navy, the US Navy, and the Japanese to great advantage.

Aircraft carriers are still crucial vehicles in naval warfare today. The USS *Harry S. Truman*, seen here, was launched in 1996 and went into active service in 2000. It is one of a fleet of ten nuclear-powered aircraft carriers currently in service with the US Navy, and is able to carry 80 aircraft, which can be moved between the flight deck and the hangars below in four elevators. It has seen military service, and also helped bring relief to the stricken victims of Hurricane Katrina in 2005.

An F/A-18A Hornet lands on the USS *Harry S. Truman*. Since its launch, the carrier has been used in action against Iraq and Afghanistan.

